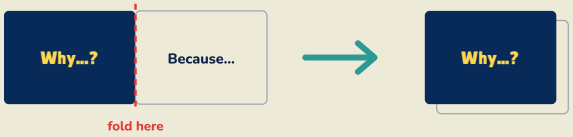
A FREE BONUS FROM THE BIG BOOK OF WHYS FOR KIDS

Why of the Day Cards

60 questions from the book. One card a day. Can you guess the answer?

Make your cards

1. **Print at 100%.** In the print window, choose "Actual size" or "100%," not "Fit to page." Plain paper works. Card stock makes stronger cards.
2. **Cut with a grown-up.** Cut each card out along the solid gray lines.
3. **Fold in half** on the dashed line. Now the question is on one side and the answer is on the other.
4. **Want them to stay shut?** Add a little glue stick inside the fold.



How to play

1. Pick one card a day.
2. Read the question out loud.
3. Everybody makes a guess. Grown-ups too!
4. Flip the card and read the answer. Who got closest?
5. Want to know more? Every card tells you the page in the book with the full answer.

GROWN-UP CHECK Scissors are sharp. Kids, cut out your cards together with a grown-up.

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ANIMALS

WHY OF THE DAY #1



Why are flamingos pink?

Make a guess first!

#1

Flamingos hatch with fluffy gray feathers. Their pink comes from their food! Tiny shrimp and algae are full of natural colors that build up in their feathers.

★ Read more on page 6

DINOSAURS

WHY OF THE DAY #2



What happened to the dinosaurs?

Make a guess first!

#2

About 66 million years ago, a giant asteroid crashed into Earth. Dust and gas darkened the sky, and Earth got cold. Many plants died, and most dinosaurs disappeared.

★ Read more on page 19

SPACE

WHY OF THE DAY #3



Why is the sky blue?

Make a guess first!

#3

Sunlight is a mix of all the colors. When it hits the tiny bits of gas in our air, blue light bounces around the most. So blue light fills the whole sky!

★ Read more on page 28

PLANET EARTH

WHY OF THE DAY #4



How do clouds float?

Make a guess first!

#4

A cloud holds tons of water, but it is split into teeny-tiny droplets. Gravity barely pulls on them. Warm rising air helps hold them up too.

★ Read more on page 39

THE HUMAN BODY

WHY OF THE DAY #5



Why do we get hiccups?

Make a guess first!

#5

Hiccups start in your diaphragm, a muscle under your lungs. Sometimes it squeezes suddenly. Air rushes in, and your vocal cords snap shut. Hic! Scientists still aren't sure why we hiccup.

★ Read more on page 50

PLANTS & BUGS

WHY OF THE DAY #6



Why are leaves green?

Make a guess first!

#6

Leaves are full of a green color called chlorophyll. It catches sunlight, and the plant uses that energy to make food. Chlorophyll is so green that it hides other colors.

★ Read more on page 61

OCEANS

WHY OF THE DAY #7



Why is the ocean salty?

Make a guess first!

#7

The salt comes from rocks on land! Rain wears away tiny bits of rock, and rivers carry the salts to the ocean. When the water dries up, the salt stays behind.

★ Read more on page 72

KITCHEN SCIENCE

WHY OF THE DAY #8



Why does popcorn pop?

Make a guess first!

#8

Each kernel has a tiny drop of water inside. Heat turns it into steam, but the hard shell traps it. The pressure builds until, POP! The kernel turns inside out.

★ Read more on page 83

HOW THINGS WORK

WHY OF THE DAY #9



How do airplanes stay up in the sky?

Make a guess first! #9

It's all about the wings! The engines push the plane forward fast. The wings push air down, and the air pushes the wings up. That upward push is called lift.

★ Read more on page 94

BRAIN & SENSES

WHY OF THE DAY #10



Why do we dream?

Make a guess first! #10

Scientists are still trying to figure this out! Most dreams happen in REM sleep, when your brain is very busy. Some think dreams sort memories. Others think they help us find new ideas.

★ Read more on page 105

ANIMALS

WHY OF THE DAY #11



Why do cats land on their feet?

Make a guess first! #11

Cats have a special move called the righting reflex. A balance sensor in the ear tells them which way is down. They turn the head first, then twist the body.

★ Read more on page 7

DINOSAURS

WHY OF THE DAY #12



Did dinosaurs have feathers?

Make a guess first! #12

Many did! Velociraptor was about the size of a turkey, and it had feathers. Scientists found bumps on its arm bone, the same bumps birds have where big feathers hold on.

★ Read more on page 20

SPACE

WHY OF THE DAY #13



Why does the Moon change shape?

Make a guess first! #13

It doesn't! The Moon is always round. The Sun lights up half of it. As the Moon travels around Earth, we see different amounts of that bright half.

★ Read more on page 29

PLANET EARTH

WHY OF THE DAY #14



How does a rainbow happen?

Make a guess first! #14

You need sunshine and raindrops. Sunlight bends inside each raindrop, and each color bends differently. The colors spread apart and bounce back out toward you. Millions of drops make a rainbow!

★ Read more on page 40

THE HUMAN BODY

WHY OF THE DAY #15



Why do we sneeze?

Make a guess first! #15

To clean out your nose! Dust, pepper, or cold air tickles inside it. Your brain tells many muscles to squeeze at once. ACHOO! The air blasts the tickly stuff away.

★ Read more on page 51

PLANTS & BUGS

WHY OF THE DAY #16



How do bees make honey?

Make a guess first! #16

Bees sip nectar from flowers and carry it to the hive. Other bees change its sugars and spread it in the honeycomb. They fan their wings to dry it into honey.

★ Read more on page 63

OCEANS

WHY OF THE DAY #17



What makes waves?

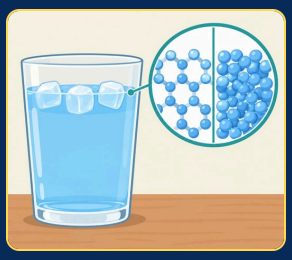
Make a guess first! #17

Mostly the wind! Wind rubs the top of the water and pushes up tiny ripples. If it keeps blowing, the ripples grow into waves. Long, strong winds make the biggest waves.

★ Read more on page 73

KITCHEN SCIENCE

WHY OF THE DAY #18



Why does ice float?

Make a guess first! #18

When water freezes, its tiny bits line up with lots of space between them. So ice takes up more room than the same water. It is lighter for its size, so it floats!

★ Read more on page 85

HOW THINGS WORK

WHY OF THE DAY #19



How does electricity get to your house?

Make a guess first! #19

It is made at a power plant. Then it travels many miles through power lines on tall towers. Transformers make it safer for homes, and wires in your walls carry it to the outlets.

★ Read more on page 95

BRAIN & SENSES

WHY OF THE DAY #20



Why does your voice sound weird on a recording?

Make a guess first! #20

You hear yourself two ways: through the air, and through the bones in your head. The bones make your voice sound deeper to you. A recording catches only the air sound.

★ Read more on page 107

ANIMALS

WHY OF THE DAY #21



How do bats fly in the dark?

Make a guess first! #21

Bats use their ears to see! They make high squeaks that bounce off things and come back. The echo tells them where things are. This is called echolocation.

★ Read more on page 8

DINOSAURS

WHY OF THE DAY #22



Could T. rex run fast?

Make a guess first! #22

Probably not! A computer test in 2017 showed its leg bones would break if it ran. T. rex probably walked fast instead, about 12 miles per hour (19 km/h).

★ Read more on page 22

SPACE

WHY OF THE DAY #23



Why do stars twinkle?

Make a guess first! #23

Starlight travels through our air to reach us. The air is always moving, with warm and cold spots. They bend the light this way and that, so the star seems to flicker.

★ Read more on page 30

PLANET EARTH

WHY OF THE DAY #24



Can lightning strike the same place twice?

Make a guess first! #24

Yes! Lightning often hits the same spot again and again, especially tall things standing alone. The Empire State Building gets hit about 23 times a year.

★ Read more on page 41

THE HUMAN BODY

WHY OF THE DAY #25



Why does everyone have different fingerprints?

Make a guess first! #25

Your fingerprints formed before you were born. Your genes set the basic pattern. Tiny things around you before birth shaped the details. Even identical twins have different fingerprints!

★ Read more on page 53

PLANTS & BUGS

WHY OF THE DAY #26



How do fireflies glow?

Make a guess first! #26

At the end of a firefly's body, two chemicals mix with oxygen and make light. Fireflies flash to talk to each other. Each kind has its own pattern, like a secret code.

★ Read more on page 64

OCEANS

WHY OF THE DAY #27



Are whales fish?

Make a guess first! #27

No! Whales are mammals, like dogs, cats, and you. They breathe air with lungs, so they swim up for each breath. Whale moms feed their babies milk.

★ Read more on page 75

KITCHEN SCIENCE

WHY OF THE DAY #28



Why don't oil and water mix?

Make a guess first! #28

Water's tiny bits stick tightly to each other, like little magnets. They push the oil away, so the oil gathers into blobs. Oil is lighter, so it floats on top.

★ Read more on page 86

HOW THINGS WORK

WHY OF THE DAY #29



How can a giant ship float?

Make a guess first! #29

A ship is heavy, but it is mostly hollow. Its wide shape pushes a lot of water out of the way. The water pushes back up hard enough to hold the ship up!

★ Read more on page 97

BRAIN & SENSES

WHY OF THE DAY #30



What is brain freeze?

Make a guess first! #30

Your brain isn't freezing! Scientists think something very cold makes tiny blood vessels in the roof of your mouth squeeze, then open. Your brain feels the pain in your forehead.

★ Read more on page 108

ANIMALS

WHY OF THE DAY #31



What is inside a camel's hump?

Make a guess first! #31

Not water! A camel's hump is full of fat. It is food stored for later. When the camel can't find food in the desert, its body uses the fat.

★ Read more on page 9

DINOSAURS

WHY OF THE DAY #32



Why did Stegosaurus have plates on its back?

Make a guess first! #32

Scientists are not sure. Most think the plates were for showing off to other Stegosaurus. Another idea is that they helped it warm up or cool down.

★ Read more on page 23

SPACE

WHY OF THE DAY #33



Why isn't Pluto a planet anymore?

Make a guess first! #33

In 2006, scientists made a new rule: a planet must clear its path of other big objects. Pluto shares its path with lots of icy objects. So now it is a dwarf planet.

★ Read more on page 32

PLANET EARTH

WHY OF THE DAY #34



How do tornadoes form?

Make a guess first! #34

Most big tornadoes come from giant thunderstorms. Winds blowing different ways make the air spin. Rising air tips the spin up on its end. Scientists are still studying what sets it off.

★ Read more on page 43

THE HUMAN BODY

WHY OF THE DAY #35



Why does your stomach growl?

Make a guess first! #35

Muscles in your stomach and intestines squeeze to push food, liquid, and air along. All that squishing rumbles. When your stomach is empty, nothing muffles the noise, so it's louder.

★ Read more on page 55

PLANTS & BUGS

WHY OF THE DAY #36



Are spiders insects?

Make a guess first! #36

Nope! Insects have six legs and three body parts. Spiders have eight legs and two body parts. So spiders are not insects. They are arachnids, like scorpions and ticks.

★ Read more on page 65

OCEANS

WHY OF THE DAY #37



Why do so many deep-sea animals glow?

Make a guess first! #37

Deep in the ocean there is no sunlight at all, so many animals make their own light. Some glow to find food, some to scare away hungry animals, and some to find a mate.

★ Read more on page 76

KITCHEN SCIENCE

WHY OF THE DAY #38



Why do chili peppers taste hot?

Make a guess first! #38

Peppers have capsaicin in them. It tricks the heat sensors in your mouth. They send a "Hot!" message to your brain, even though nothing is really hot.

★ Read more on page 88

HOW THINGS WORK

WHY OF THE DAY #39



How does a toilet flush?

Make a guess first! #39

The handle lifts a rubber flap, and about two gallons (8 liters) of water rush into the bowl. A curved pipe fills up and pulls the water out, like a straw. WHOOSH!

★ Read more on page 98

BRAIN & SENSES

WHY OF THE DAY #40



Do we only use 10 percent of our brain?

Make a guess first! #40

Nope! That is a famous myth. Brain scans show that almost every part of the brain has a job. Over a whole day, you use just about all of it, even when you sleep.

★ Read more on page 110

ANIMALS

WHY OF THE DAY #41



How can geckos walk up walls?

Make a guess first! #41

Gecko toes are covered in millions of tiny hairs. Each tip pulls on the wall just a tiny bit. Millions of tips together pull a lot! To let go, geckos peel their toes up.

★ Read more on page 12

DINOSAURS

WHY OF THE DAY #42



Were flying reptiles dinosaurs?

Make a guess first! #42

No! Flying reptiles called pterosaurs lived at the same time as dinosaurs, but they were close cousins. Their wings were skin stretched over one very long finger.

★ Read more on page 24

SPACE

WHY OF THE DAY #43



What are Saturn's rings made of?

Make a guess first! #43

Billions of pieces of ice and rock! Some are as small as dust. Others are as big as a house. They all zoom around Saturn together.

★ Read more on page 33

PLANET EARTH

WHY OF THE DAY #44



Why do volcanoes erupt?

Make a guess first! #44

Deep underground, rock melts into magma. Magma has gas in it, like the bubbles in a soda. As it rises, the bubbles push harder and harder until the volcano erupts!

★ Read more on page 44

THE HUMAN BODY

WHY OF THE DAY #45



Why do baby teeth fall out?

Make a guess first! #45

Grown-up teeth form under your gums while you grow. When one is ready, it pushes on a baby tooth. The baby tooth's root breaks down, and the tooth wiggles out.

★ Read more on page 56

PLANTS & BUGS

WHY OF THE DAY #46



How does a Venus flytrap catch bugs?

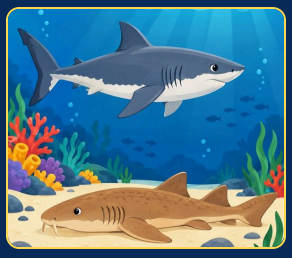
Make a guess first! #46

Its trap has tiny trigger hairs inside. When a bug touches a hair twice, the trap snaps shut in about a tenth of a second. Two touches keep it from closing on raindrops.

★ Read more on page 67

OCEANS

WHY OF THE DAY #47



Do sharks sleep?

Make a guess first! #47

Scientists are still figuring this out! Nurse sharks can rest on the seafloor. Great whites must keep swimming to breathe. Some sharks may rest while they swim slowly.

★ Read more on page 77

KITCHEN SCIENCE

WHY OF THE DAY #48



Why do bananas get brown spots?

Make a guess first! #48

The spots mean the banana is getting riper. Inside, the starch turns into sugar, so it gets sweeter and softer. A gas from the banana breaks down the yellow in the peel.

★ Read more on page 89

HOW THINGS WORK

WHY OF THE DAY #49



Why do helium balloons float?

Make a guess first! #49

Helium is much lighter than air. A helium balloon weighs less than the air around it. The heavier air pushes in underneath and lifts the balloon up, up, up!

★ Read more on page 99

BRAIN & SENSES

WHY OF THE DAY #50



Do carrots help you see in the dark?

Make a guess first! #50

Not really! Extra carrots won't give you night vision. The story spread in World War II. It helped hide a secret machine that let British pilots find planes at night.

★ Read more on page 111

ANIMALS

WHY OF THE DAY #51



Why do skunks smell so bad?

Make a guess first! #51

The smell means "Leave me alone!" First a skunk stomps, raises its tail, and hisses. If that doesn't work, it sprays. The spray can reach about 10 feet (3 meters).

★ Read more on page 14

DINOSAURS

WHY OF THE DAY #52



Can scientists bring dinosaurs back?

Make a guess first! #52

Sadly, no. Scientists would need dinosaur DNA, the instructions inside every living thing. But DNA falls apart over time. After 66 million years, none is left.

★ Read more on page 26

SPACE

WHY OF THE DAY #53



Are astronaut footprints still on the Moon?

Make a guess first!

#53

Yes! Astronauts walked there more than 50 years ago. The Moon has almost no air, so there is no wind or rain to wipe the footprints away.

★ Read more on page 34

PLANET EARTH

WHY OF THE DAY #54



Why do we have day and night?

Make a guess first!

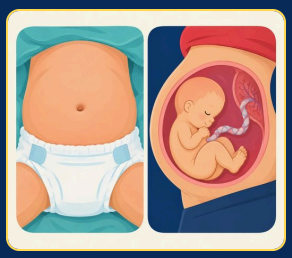
#54

Earth spins like a top, once every 24 hours. The Sun lights up only half of Earth at a time. Your side faces the Sun for day, then turns away for night.

★ Read more on page 46

THE HUMAN BODY

WHY OF THE DAY #55



Why do we have belly buttons?

Make a guess first!

#55

Before you were born, a soft tube called the umbilical cord brought you food and oxygen. After birth, it was clipped. Your belly button is where it used to be.

★ Read more on page 57

PLANTS & BUGS

WHY OF THE DAY #56



Why do ladybugs have spots?

Make a guess first!

#56

The bright colors are a warning! They tell birds that ladybugs taste terrible. Birds remember the colors and stay away. The red shell is really a pair of wing covers.

★ Read more on page 70

OCEANS

WHY OF THE DAY #57



Can you really hear the ocean in a seashell?

Make a guess first! #57

No! You hear the quiet sounds around you, like voices, cars, and fans. The curved inside of the shell makes some of them louder. Together, they sound like waves.

★ Read more on page 79

KITCHEN SCIENCE

WHY OF THE DAY #58



Why does chocolate melt in your hand?

Make a guess first! #58

Chocolate has cocoa butter in it, which starts to melt at about 86°F (30°C). Your body is about 98.6°F (37°C). That is too warm for chocolate!

★ Read more on page 91

HOW THINGS WORK

WHY OF THE DAY #59



Does a mirror really flip left and right?

Make a guess first! #59

No! Raise your right hand. Your reflection raises the hand on that same side. What a mirror really flips is front and back. Your brain just thinks left and right swapped.

★ Read more on page 102

BRAIN & SENSES

WHY OF THE DAY #60



Why do songs get stuck in your head?

Make a guess first! #60

A stuck song is called an earworm. Earworms are often songs you heard not long ago. They have an easy tune that is fun to sing, plus one little surprise that grabs your brain.

★ Read more on page 113

Thanks for wondering with us!

You did it! That's 60 whys, one card at a time.

Every card comes from **The Big Book of Whys for Kids**. The book has 200 questions in all. Each one has a **How We Know** box that shows how scientists found out, and a **Did You Know?** fact to share.

Want to see where every answer comes from? The full list of sources is on the same page where you found these cards.

A note for grown-ups

If this book helped answer some "why?" questions at your house, we would be grateful for an honest review on Amazon. Your words help other parents and grandparents decide if the book is right for their kids.

Thank you for reading together.

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